

N8N COMPLETE COURSE · MODULE 1 — FOUNDATIONS

# Setting Up n8n: Cloud vs Self-Hosted

Lesson 02 · Your account goes live today

14-Day Free Trial

No Credit Card

Account in 5 Minutes

SolutionsWithShahzain

# Today's Plan



## Two ways to run n8n

Cloud vs self-hosted — what each actually means



## Which one fits YOU

An honest decision table + our course path



## Live: create your account

Together, step by step, on screen



## The trial, honestly

What's free, for how long, and what happens after

# Two Ways to Run n8n



## n8n Cloud

- Runs on n8n's servers — you just log in
- Nothing to install, nothing to maintain
- Ready in 5 minutes from any browser
- Paid after trial (\$24/mo Starter)



## Self-Hosted

- Runs on YOUR computer or server (Docker)
- Free forever — unlimited workflows
- You handle updates, backups, security
- One-time setup effort (Module 6, together)

*Think: hotel room (serviced, rented) vs your own house (yours forever, you maintain it).*

# Cloud or Self-Hosted — For You?

|              | n8n Cloud               | Self-Hosted            |
|--------------|-------------------------|------------------------|
| Setup time   | 5 minutes               | 1–2 hours (first time) |
| Cost         | Free 14 days → \$24/mo  | Free forever           |
| Maintenance  | n8n handles everything  | You handle it          |
| Data control | n8n's servers (EU/US)   | 100% on your machine   |
| Best while   | Learning & starting out | Client work & scaling  |

**Our path:** Cloud today (learning, zero friction) → Docker self-host in Module 6 (free forever). *Verified July 2026*

# What is an 'Instance'?

**Your instance = your own private copy of n8n**

- Gets its own address: `yourname.app.n8n.cloud`
- Your workflows, your data, your credentials — only yours
- Cloud or self-hosted, the word means the same thing



**Like your WhatsApp number**

Same app as everyone else — but your number, your chats, your contacts. Nobody else can see them.

# Let's Create Your Account — Live

1

**Go to n8n.io → 'Get started for free'**

Use a REAL email — verification will arrive

2

**Set password + workspace name**

Workspace name becomes your instance URL

3

**Answer the short onboarding questions**

Anything works — it just personalizes tips

4

**Land on your dashboard**

That's it — your instance is live

NO SURPRISES

# The Free Trial, Honestly

14 days

full features, free

No card

needed for the trial

\$24/mo

Starter plan, after trial

Trial ends — then what? Two honest options: pay for Cloud, or self-host for free (Module 6 — we'll do it together).

**Nothing is lost either way: workflows export with one click.**

*Pricing verified July 2026 — check [n8n.io/pricing](https://n8n.io/pricing) for current numbers*

SAVE YOURSELF THE PAIN

# Common Beginner Mistakes



## Signing up with a temp/fake email

Verification and account recovery both break. Use your real inbox.



## Trying to self-host on day one

Classic complexity trap — you'll spend a week on servers instead of learning n8n. Module 6 exists for a reason.



## Not starting because 'trial khatam ho jayega'

14 days easily covers Modules 1–2 of this course. Start now.



## Clicking everything in the dashboard today

Patience — the full UI tour is the very next lesson.



# Your Assignment



Get your n8n instance live before the next lesson.

1

**Create your account**

n8n.io → free trial — exactly as we did on screen

2

**Log in & just look around**

Don't build anything yet — that starts in Lesson 4

3

**Comment your workspace name**

So I know you're ready for the UI tour

*Lesson 1 assignment bhi yaad hai na? Apne 3 repetitive tasks ready rakho — jald automate karenge.*

# Key Takeaways

1

Cloud = fastest start, zero maintenance — perfect while learning

2

Self-hosted = free forever, full control — we go there in Module 6

3

Your instance is live: 14-day trial, no card, nothing to lose

4

Next up: the full UI tour, then your first real workflow

COMING UP NEXT

# Lesson 03 — The n8n Interface Tour

## Your instance, fully explained

- The canvas — where workflows come to life
- Panels, executions & settings — what matters, what can wait
- So that in Lesson 4, we build for real



Free notes + workflows  
[github.com/Shahzain-Ali/n8n-mastery](https://github.com/Shahzain-Ali/n8n-mastery)



Subscribe — 2 lessons  
every week, free forever

**SolutionsWithShahzain — the free n8n course that feels premium**



[linkedin.com/in/shahzain-ali1](https://linkedin.com/in/shahzain-ali1)



[instagram.com/shahzainlibangash1](https://instagram.com/shahzainlibangash1)



[facebook.com/shahzainlibangash1](https://facebook.com/shahzainlibangash1)